
Which prompt is worth polishing first?
A
Daily support summary
Estimated time saved/month:
100 minutes
B
Weekly meeting recap
Estimated time saved/month:
40 minutes
C
Quarterly report outline
Estimated time saved/month:
30 minutes

# What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

## The problem

A student has several prompts but limited time to polish and present them. Choosing by novelty alone can overlook a simple prompt that solves a frequent task.

TARGET

## Learning goal

Compare candidate prompts using practical value, reuse, output quality, and a modest time-saved estimate.

**Practice material:** Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

# Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

## Practice candidates (fictional estimates)

- A: format a daily 10-minute support summary, used 20 times/month; B: draft a weekly 20-minute meeting recap, used 4 times/month; C: outline a quarterly 60-minute report, used once/month. Estimate each saves half the original time: A saves 5 minutes/use, B 10, C 30.

BOUNDARY

## Use the supplied facts

A student has several prompts but limited time to polish and present them. Choosing by novelty alone can overlook a simple prompt that solves a frequent task.

# Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

## Calculate an estimate before ranking

- Estimated monthly time saved equals minutes saved per use multiplied by monthly uses. From the fictional candidates, A is 5 x 20 = 100 minutes, B is 10 x 4 = 40 minutes, and C is 30 x 1 = 30 minutes. These are estimates based on the exercise assumption that each prompt saves half the original time, not measured or guaranteed savings.

LEARN

## Compare value and risk, not just a large number

- A prompt used often may be more useful than a dramatic one-off task. Consider usefulness, repeat frequency, consistent output, ease of reuse, and the cost of an error. A high estimated time saving does not make a prompt safe or accurate. Score candidates with the same criteria so the comparison is fair.

# Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

## Test the leading prompt on fresh input

- Choose one prompt to polish, then ask a partner to run it with a new input. Record one quality issue and whether the prompt handled the new case. Explain one reason not to choose each alternative. Do not convert saved minutes into a money claim unless a separate, supported cost calculation is available.

APPLY

## Three-step method

- Estimate time saved; score prompts against shared criteria; select one to improve and explain the trade-off.

# What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

**POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE**

AI Chat

You

Which prompt is the coolest?

Message AI...

**POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE**

AI Chat

You

Pick the highest-scoring one and say it will save money.

Message AI...

# A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

**IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND**

AI Chat

You

For each candidate, calculate estimated minutes saved per month from the figures below.
Show the multiplication and label results as estimates.

Message AI...

**IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND**

AI Chat

You

Compare the three prompts on usefulness, repeat frequency, consistency,
ease of reuse, and error risk (low/medium/high). Recommend one to polish first
and state one reason not to choose each alternative. Do not claim measured savings.

Message AI...

# Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

## Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Calculate A = 100 minutes/month, B = 40, C = 30. Score each from 1-3 on usefulness and ease of reuse; add an error-risk note. Discuss why estimated time alone is not the whole decision.

# Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

## Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Bring two prompts from earlier sessions. Have a partner test each with a new input, record one quality issue, and choose which prompt is most ready to document.

# Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W15_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

## One report for this session

- Introduction: Explain why choosing a prompt by novelty alone can be a mistake.
- Method: Copy the two prompts you brought from earlier sessions.
- Results: Include the comparison table with time-saved calculations, scores, error-risk notes, and the quality issue your partner found.
- Conclusion: Give a short recommendation with one caveat.

# How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

## Success check

- The time calculations are correct, estimates are labeled, and the recommendation considers quality and risk as well as frequency.